



88-acre city for car test

Called City-X, South Korea is building a 88-acre 'city' for tech and auto companies to test autonomous cars. <http://digit.in/Kcity>



Extracting methane hydrate

Teams from China and Japan are successfully extracting methane hydrate from the seafloor and this is a big deal. <http://digit.in/MethSea>

ASUS ROG GX800

Defining overkill

The ASUS ROG GX800 has quite a few improvements over the ROG GX700 of which a few things stand out prominently. It sports an Intel Core i7-7820HK Kaby Lake processor which has a base frequency of 2.9 GHz and a boost frequency of 3.9 GHz. However, since the ASUS ROG GX800 has the Hydro Overclocking System for liquid cooling, they reportedly run the processor at 3.2 GHz at all times and when docked, the clock speed can hit a peak of 4.4 GHz. In case you're wondering what the Hydro Overclocking System is, it's that large attachment onto which the gaming laptop is seated to make the most of it.

Speaking of the Hydro Overclocking System, it consists of two radiators with individual fans for each radiator. These fans were calibrated with a factory preset load line on the ROG GX700 but with the ROG GX800, you now have control over the RPM. So you can have your own cooling presets which can be set in ASUS' Gaming Center software.

While NVIDIA has launched the desktop GTX 1080 Ti, the laptop variant has only recently been announced. So we do see the GTX 1080 Ti in the ASUS ROG GX800, instead it has two GTX 1080s in SLI which is a pretty good deal for gaming. More than sufficient to run AAA games at UHD resolution on Ultra settings. And to help with visual experience, the display panel is an 18.4-inch UHD panel with NVIDIA G-SYNC so you'll experience no frame tearing. Also, the GTX 1080s are clocked at 1632 MHz and a boost clock of 1821 MHz. We managed to get a Fire Strike score of 24,468 which is ridiculously high. To put things into perspective, we tested the 1050 Ti based MSI GE62 7RE and that scored 7943 in the same test. So with two GTX 1080s you've got three

times the synthetic score. However, gaming performance doesn't always scale the same way synthetic benchmarks do.

Next up is the RAM. The 64 GB of RAM that the GX800 comes with should be more than sufficient for anything

As for the storage, the ROG GX800 has three Toshiba 512 GB NVMe SSDs with RAID 0 support. Game load times are really fast with such a setup. Even the operating system feels ridiculously snappy thanks to the fast SSD as well as Intel's improved Speed Shift in Kaby Lake CPUs.

The keyboard is another upgrade. ASUS says they're mechanical keys with 2.5 mm travel distance and they have tactile feedback. They're calling it MechTAG (short for Mechanical Tactile Advanced Gaming) keyboard and it has 30-key rollover, and RGB Aura backlighting. The Gaming Center software does have plenty of options to play around with the RGB Aura lighting and allows for customization too.

Needless to say, the SLI configuration makes the unit power hungry and for that they have two 330W power supplies which plug into the laptop and water cooling unit separately.



Price
₹7,97,990



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Depending on which game you are playing and at which settings, the laptop can reportedly provide an hour's worth of game time and with the cooling unit, that drops down further. Though we're wondering who'd pull out such a beefy laptop for just a 30 min quickie.

Aside from the Acer Predator 21 X, this is the most ridiculously high-specced laptops we've come across. There's the obvious disadvantage with regards to heft as this is the most heaviest laptop that we've had the pleasure of testing. The entire unit comes with its own suitcase which has all the requisite padding to transport the ₹7,97,990 laptop around. If you have the money and don't mind carrying a suitcase around, then the GX800 is one of the few units that checks all the boxes.

—Mithun Mohandas

SPECIFICATIONS

PROCESSOR: Intel Core i7 7820HK | RAM: 64 GB 2800 MHz DDR4 | SCREEN SIZE: 18.4-inches | SCREEN RESOLUTION: 3840x2160 | GPU: 2x GTX 1080 8GB SLI | SSD: 3x 512GB M.2 NVMe SSD in RAID 0 | ETHERNET: Gigabit Ethernet | BATTERY: 8-Cell 76 Whr | AC ADAPTER: 2x 330 W | WEIGHT: 5.7 kg.

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